Columbia University: Arts & Sciences
A&S Fall 2020 Standard Evaluation

Course: EEEBUN3005_001_2020_3-INTRO-STAT-ECOLOGY&EVOLBIOL: EEEBUN3005_001_2020_3 - INTRO-STAT-ECOLOGY & EVOL BIOL

Instructor: Steffen Foerster

TA: Rachel Cohen * ,Dean Bobo

Response Rate: 30/40 (75.00 %)

1 - What are the strengths and weaknesses of Rachel Cohen (discussion section leader, lab section leader, grader) as an instructor, and how might Rachel Cohen's teaching be improved?

Response Rate	17/40 (42.5%)

• Rachel lead a lab section and graded alternating assignments. She clearly has a solid background in statistics, and at times this made it challenging for her to explain things to students who have basic misunderstandings of the material. She is very patient and clearly put in a lot of effort to provide students with as much support and assistance as she could. Given the disorganization of the course, I think she did the absolute best she could.

• Rachel was an incredible teaching assistant (thank you Rachel!) who's clear and concise explanations of course material helped me greatly in this class. Rachel's feedback and explanations always helped reinforce my understanding of course material and reinforced my learning experience.

• She did great with lab. Was very helpful with office hours and also graded relatively easy. She did give too much time to people's error fixing rather than the actual concepts of stats.

• Rachel was exceptionally helpful. She held consistent office hours and often re-taught during lab.

• Rachel was a phenomenal TA. She was willing to teach and provided clear and insightful explanations. I felt she was available for 1-on-1 Zooms and via email at all times which was incredibly helpful given the online format.

• Rachel is AMAZING!!! She is so understanding and I am such a big fan of her. She grades fairly and fast. If Rachel taught a class I would take it.

• Rachel is probably the only reason I managed to understand this course. She was very available with office hours and answering emails with questions. She also was able to explain the coding and meaning behind the coding very clearly. She also made sure that everyone who had questions during lab or office hours had a chance to ask them.

• Very nice but confusing to listen to when explaining things. Sometimes I felt like she only knew just as much as me...

• Rachel was super knowledgeable and had students best interest in mind.

• It was a pleasure having Rachel as a TA. She was very accessible and gave prompt replies to emails. Whenever she didn't have an answer on class logistics, she was sure to ask the professor for clarification and relay the information to the students. Her explanations were very clear and I appreciated that she tried to lead students to an answer rather than straight up giving them the answer. Grading for hw and lab assignments was returned in a timely manner for the most part. One small area of improvement I would suggest is to be more clear about the number of points each assignment is worth. For example, sometimes the gradebook would say that a lab is worth 3 points when we turned it in but later after it was graded it would be worth 5 points.

• So kind and accommodating she always made time to meet with students individually even outside of her office hours if they needed it. She was so helpful in the course and helped clear up many gaps in knowledge from lecture.

• Excellent responsiveness and very good at helping during labs.

• Rachel was so willing to help us, both in class and in lab. Especially when a few of us expressed concerns about being extremely confused in class, she listened, validated it, and went to speak to the professor directly. She is the best!

• she is extremely kind and helpful! she was so patient with me over the entire course and gave me encouraging feedback.

• Rachel is so helpful and knowledgeable about the subject. She was great at answering questions in a way that allowed you to walk through the problems and better understand what you were trying to achieve as a way to guide us in the right direction. She was extremely responsive to emails and overall just very available to help.

• Excellent. Really worked with the students in labs and via email to help troubleshoot problems, provide guidance, etc.

• Rachel was an amazing instructor. She was patient and more than willing to explain a concept multiple times. I really appreciate the effort and time she took in answering every question and making sure she answered our questions

2 - What is the overall teaching effectiveness of Rachel Cohen in the current modality?

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means
Excellent	(5)	18	64.29%		4.54
Very Good	(4)	8	28.57%		
Good	(3)	1	3.57%		
Fair	(2)	1	3.57%		
Poor	(1)	0	0.00%		
				0 25 50 100	Question

Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median
28/40 (70.00%)	4.54	0.74	5.00